

WADDINGS AND FILLINGS

Wadding is the soft middle layer between the quilt top and the backing that gives a quilt its plushness and warmth. It is available in a variety of different materials and thicknesses, depending on your preferences and needs. Knowing a little about what

options are available will help you choose the right wadding or filling for your project. Always follow the manufacturer's instructions for washing and quilting the wadding you choose.

Cotton

100 per cent cotton is a natural, warm, and breathable choice. Cotton wadding can shrink significantly during washing (about 5 per cent), which gives the quilt a slight texture and a more traditional look. Because of this you may wish to pre-wash it.

Poly/cotton blend

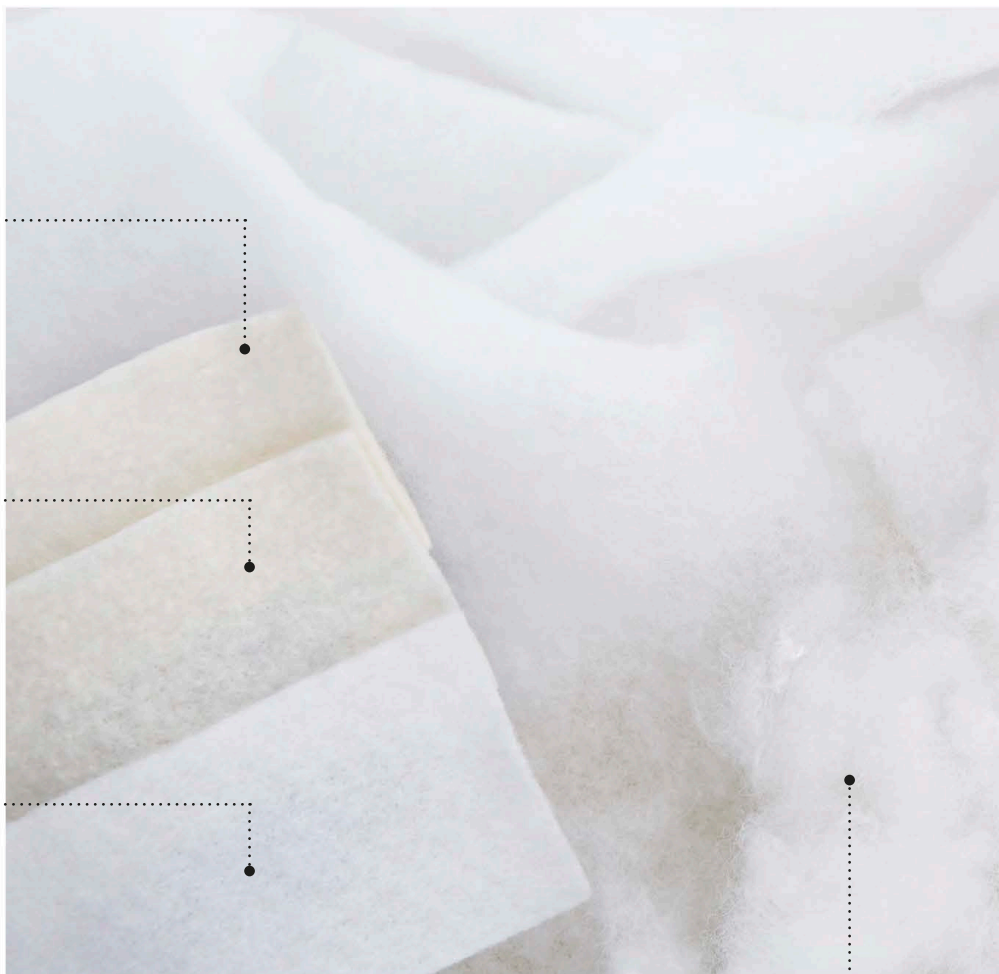
A synthetic/natural blend gives you the best of both worlds. These waddings are machine washable and will not shrink as much as 100 per cent cotton waddings.

The cotton part may shrink during washing though, so it may be wise to pre-wash it.

Polyester

Polyester waddings are light in weight, available in many thicknesses, and usually inexpensive. But being synthetic, they do not breathe well and are more flammable than a natural wadding; therefore, they are not recommended for baby quilts.

They do not shrink, so you should not need to pre-wash.



Toy filling

The most commonly used and inexpensive type of toy filling is made from polyester, but cotton (including organic cotton), wool, and even bamboo are also available.